



Startup Mindset with Agile and AI

From Idea to MVP Using Scrum

A comprehensive 3-day workshop designed for post-graduate to master the integration of AI tools with Agile methodologies. Transform your startup ideas into validated MVPs using Scrum, Lean Startup principles, and cutting-edge AI assistance.

Waleed Kamel

Your Agile AI Workshop Coach

Waleed is a seasoned Digital Transformation Leader with over 20 years of experience, specializing in driving large-scale change and implementing enterprise platforms in complex, regulated industries.

Expertise & Leadership

- Former Managing Director & CDO, adept at aligning business strategy, technology, data, and change.
- Expert in translating business needs into Agile delivery roadmaps.
- Led and coached cross-functional teams of 100+ across product, engineering, data, and operations.
- Hands-on experience applying AI and data analytics to improve decisions, customer experience, and efficiency.
- Advisor on digital business models, including FRA-compliant real estate tech.

Education

- MBA, ESLSCA Business School, France
- B.Sc. in Computers & Systems Engineering, Egypt

Certifications

- Digital Transformation Platform Strategies, MIT
- Artificial Intelligence: Implications for Business Strategy, MIT
- FinTech & Leading Digital Transformation, Silicon Valley
- Certified Product Manager (CPM)
- Agile Project Management Certified PMI-ACP
- Certified COBIT 2019 & AWS Cloud Practitioner



Outcomes by Day

Day 1: Discovery

Idea validation, personas, MVP scope using Lean Startup method, ChatGPT, and build MVP with Lovable

Day 2: Process

Scrum framework, backlog management, prioritization, project planning, and Jira setup

Day 3: Execution

Sprint execution, Zoom AI summaries, Make automation, and Gamma pitch deck

Every day produces tangible outputs you can use immediately in your startup journey.

Workshop Kickoff: Setting the Foundation

Clear Outcomes

Each day produces tangible outputs. We prioritize speed and clarity over perfection, ensuring you leave with actionable deliverables.

Team Structure

Product Owner drives value, Scrum Master removes impediments, Developers own delivery and technical quality.

AI Toolchain

ChatGPT, Claude, Make, Zapier, Lovable, NotebookLM, Gamma, and Jira work together to accelerate every phase from discovery to deployment.

Working agreements and timeboxes will be established to ensure efficient collaboration throughout the workshop. This structured approach creates transparency and sets expectations early.

Tools We'll Use



ChatGPT & Claude

AI-powered thinking, writing, and content generation for rapid ideation and refinement



Make, Zapier & Lovable

Build MVP quickly and automate feedback workflows without heavy coding



Gamma & Jira

Create pitch decks and manage Scrum execution professionally



Zoom AI

Auto-summarize meetings and extract action items for team continuity



📅 DAY 2

Day 2 Goal

Delivery System & Process

Convert Day 1 into a delivery system

Transform discovery insights into executable work

Establish Scrum process and backlog

Create the framework for consistent delivery

Set up Jira for professional execution

Build the operational infrastructure for your team

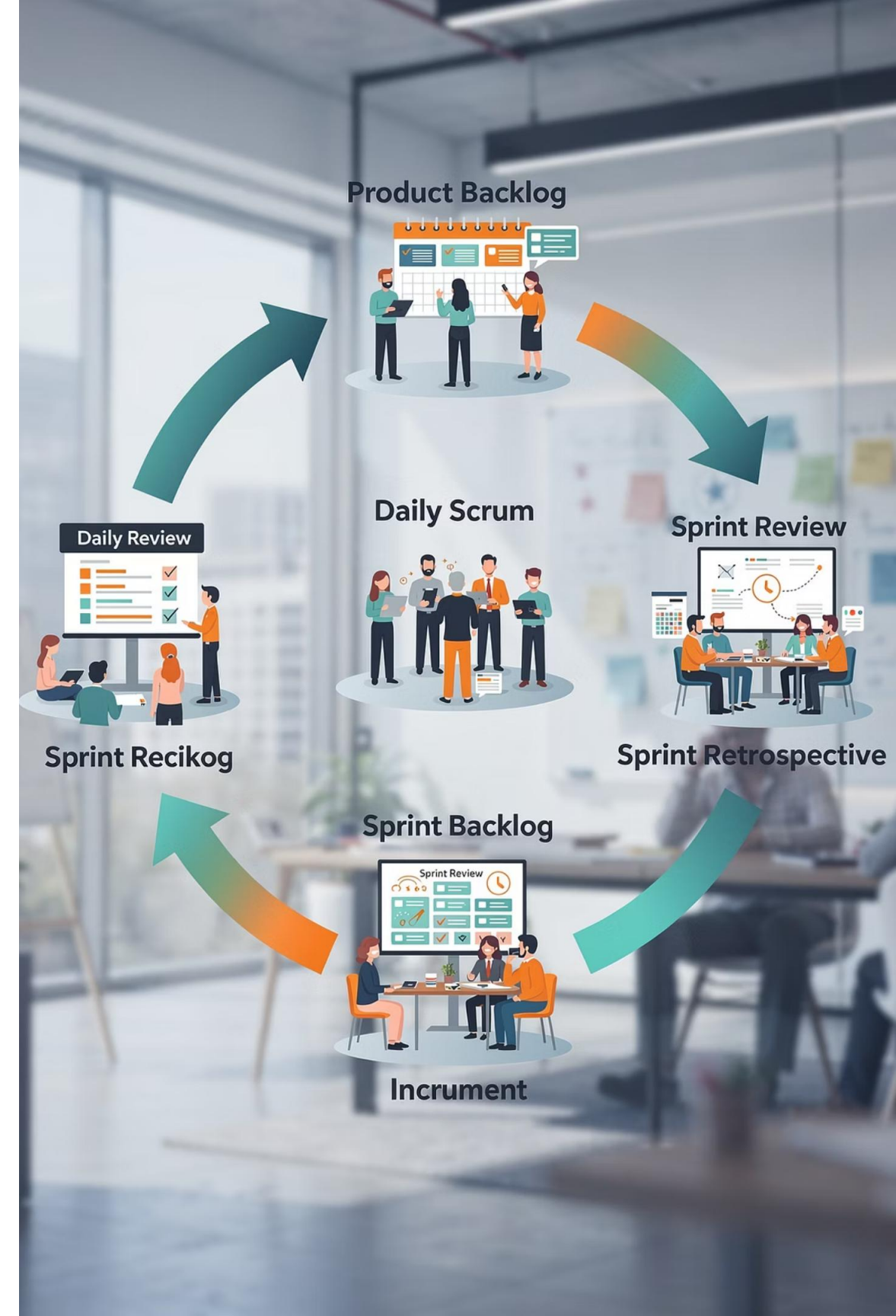
Today is about professionalizing execution (moving from scrappy MVP to sustainable product development).

Scrum in One Sentence

Deliver Value

Scrum is a framework to deliver value in increments with frequent inspection and adaptation.

Keep it simple, then expand. Scrum provides structure without rigidity, enabling teams to respond to change while maintaining consistent delivery.



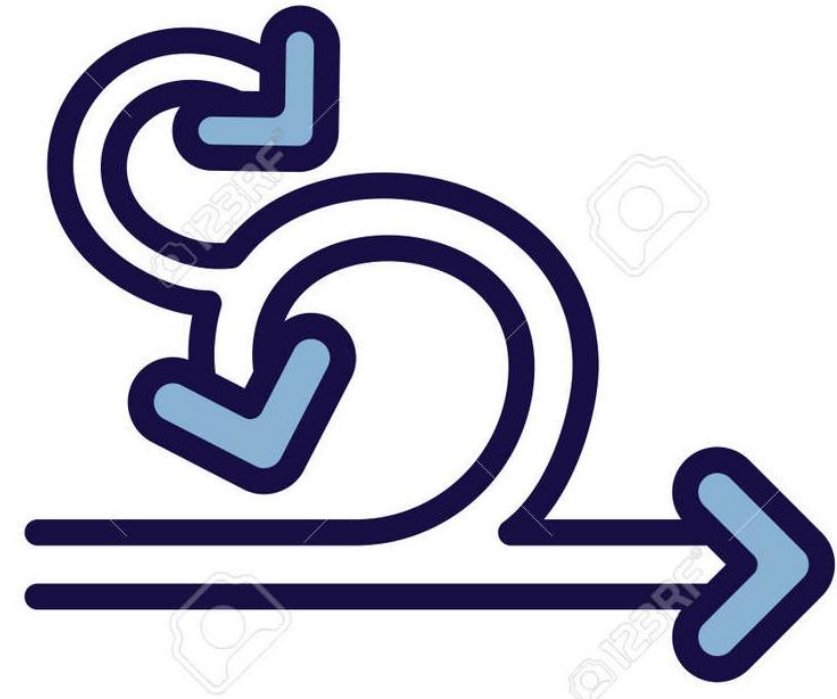
Scrum Foundations and Operating Model

What is Scrum?

Scrum is a framework for delivering value in increments. It creates transparency through defined roles, events, and artifacts. The cadence is simple: plan, execute, review, improve.

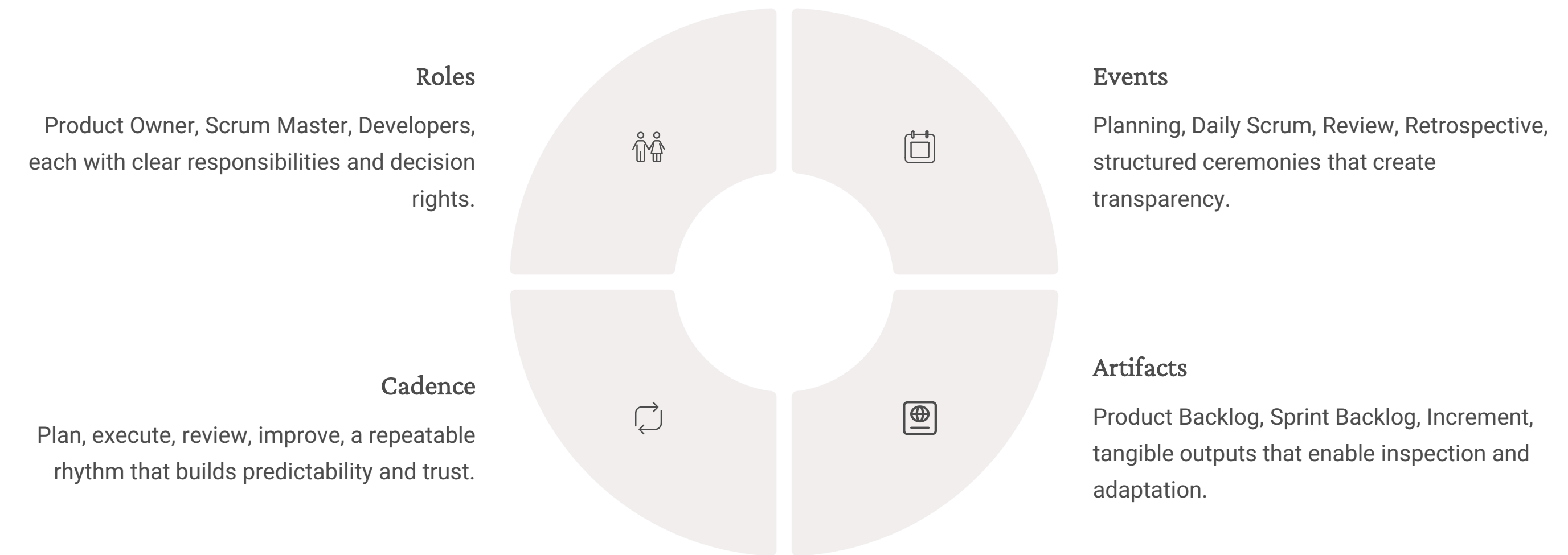
Why Scrum for Startups?

Lean helps decide what to build. Scrum helps build it reliably with continuous learning. Together, they form a complete system for product development under uncertainty.



Scrum Foundations and Operating Model

Scrum is a framework for delivering value in increments. While Lean Startup helps you decide *what* to build, Scrum helps you build it reliably with continuous learning and adaptation.





Scrum Roles

Why They Exist

Product Owner

Owns value and priorities. Decides what to build and in what order based on user needs and business goals.

Scrum Master

Owns process and team effectiveness. Removes impediments and ensures the team follows Scrum principles.

Developers

Build the increment. Self-organize to deliver working software that meets the Definition of Done.

Clarify boundaries early to avoid chaos. Each role has distinct responsibilities that complement each other.

Role Boundaries

Common Mistakes

✘ PO Micromanaging "How"

Product Owner dictates implementation details instead of defining outcomes and priorities

✘ Scrum Master as Project Manager

Scrum Master assigns tasks and tracks hours instead of coaching the team and removing impediments

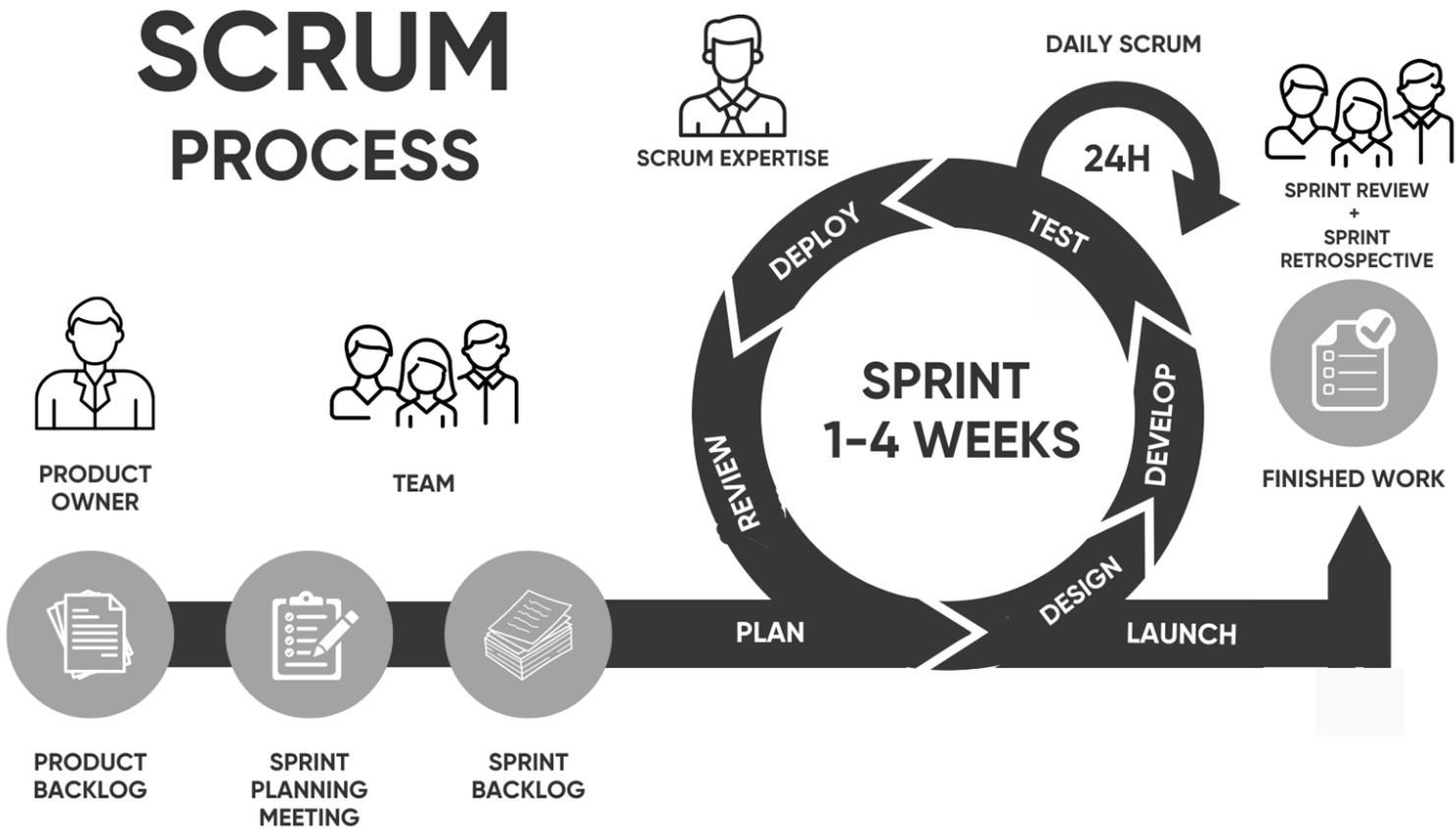
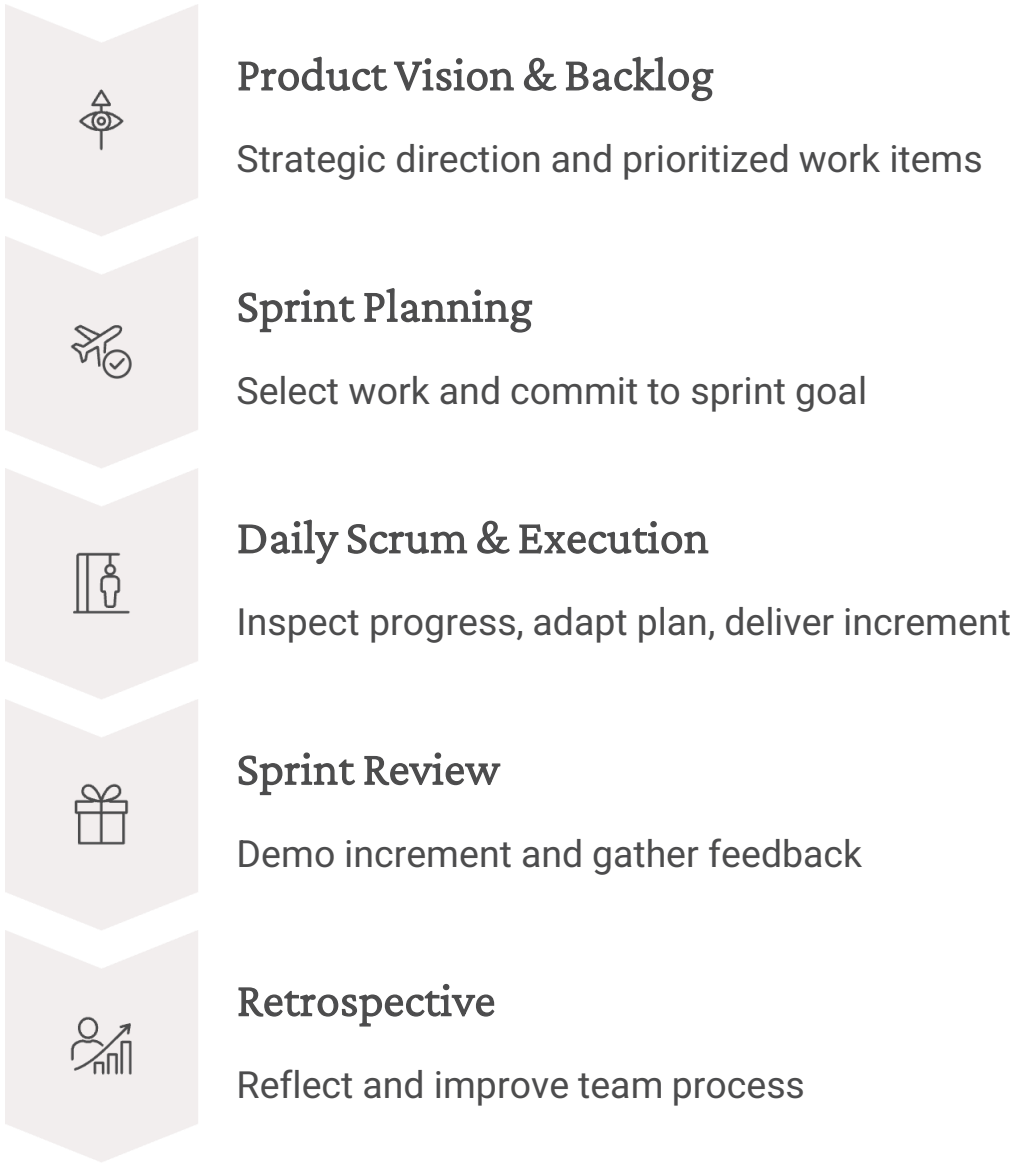
✘ Developers Waiting for Perfect Requirements

Team refuses to start work until every detail is specified, missing the point of iterative development

Call out anti-patterns early to establish healthy team dynamics from the start.

The Scrum Process

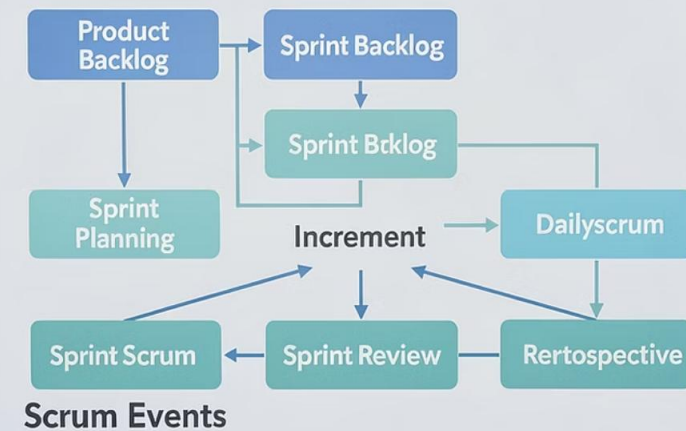
End-to-End Flow



This is the mental map for the day—understand how each piece connects to create a complete delivery system.

Scrum Events and Artifacts in Detail

Scrum Artifacts & Events



Events: Structured Ceremonies

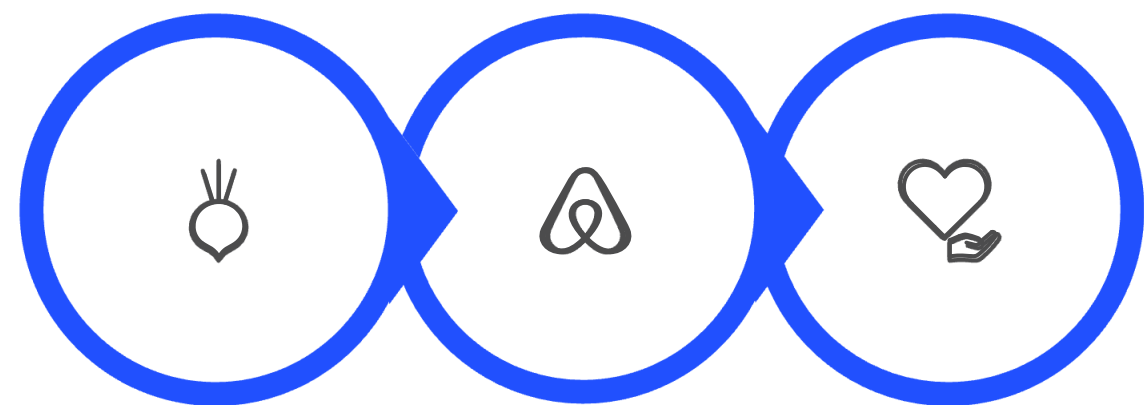
- **Sprint Planning:** Define goal and commit to scope (2-4 hours for 2-week sprint)
- **Daily Scrum:** 15-minute sync on progress and blockers
- **Sprint Review:** Demo increment and gather feedback (1-2 hours)
- **Sprint Retrospective:** Improve team process (1 hour)

Artifacts: Transparency Tools

- **Product Backlog:** Ordered list of all product work
- **Sprint Backlog:** Stories and tasks for current sprint
- **Increment:** Working, tested product slice
- **Definition of Done:** Quality checklist for all work

Artifacts are not documents—they're mechanisms for transparency and alignment. They make work visible and enable informed decisions.

AI-Assisted Product Workflow



ChatGPT
Drafts

Claude
Reviews

Team Finalizes

ChatGPT: Draft Creation

Use ChatGPT to draft PRD sections, epics, user stories, and acceptance criteria. It accelerates the initial creation phase significantly.

Human: Final Judgment

Team applies human judgment, testing mindset, and domain knowledge to finalize. AI accelerates, humans decide.

Claude: Quality Review

Claude reviews drafts for clarity, completeness, and edge cases. It catches gaps and ambiguities that humans might miss.

❑ Use AI to accelerate drafts, then apply human judgment and testing mindset to finalize. AI is a tool for speed, not a replacement for thinking.

The Product Backlog

What It Is

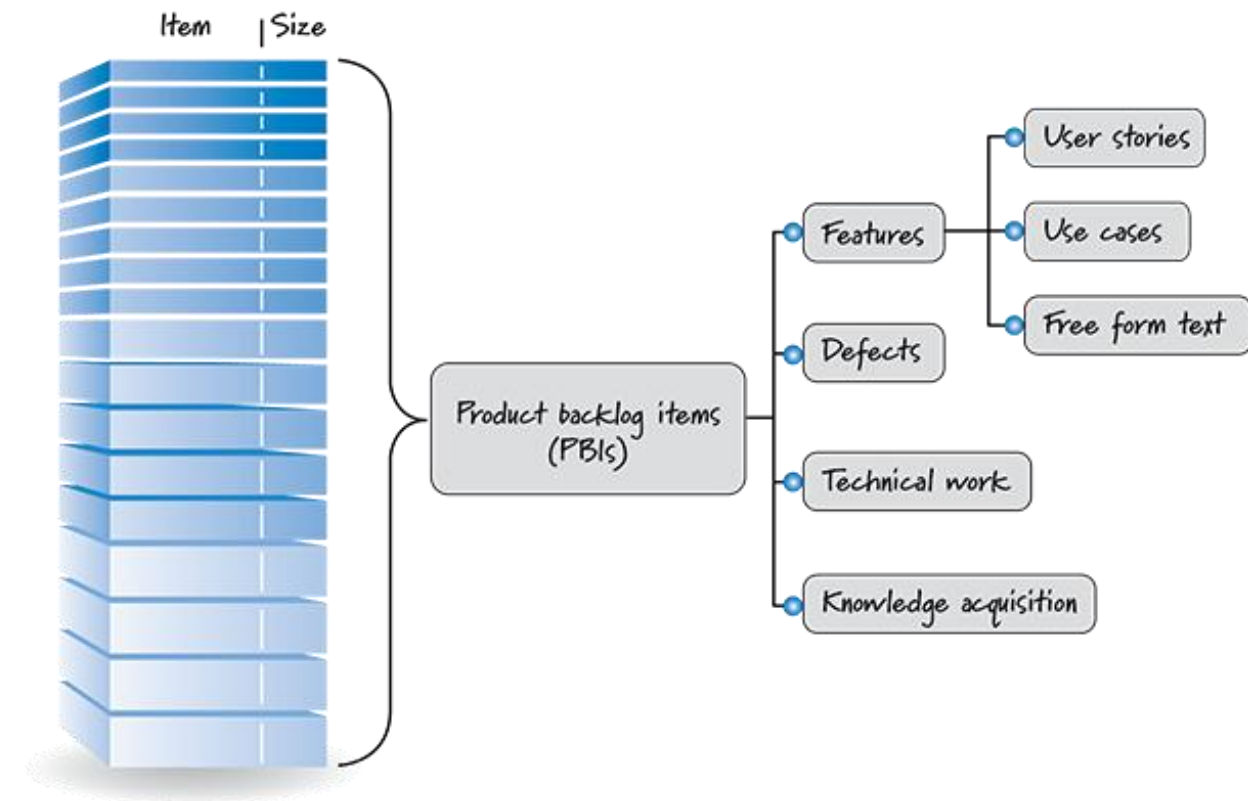
An ordered list of everything needed for the product. Continuously evolving and detailed as needed.

Who Owns It

Product Owner owns and maintains it. Team refines it collaboratively during backlog refinement sessions.

Why It Matters

Backlog quality determines sprint quality. Weak backlog causes rework, confusion, and missed sprint goals.



The Product Backlog: Your Single Source of Truth

1

Ordered List

An ordered list of everything needed for the product. Order reflects priority, not just importance—what should be built next.

2

Continuously Evolving

The backlog is never complete. It grows and changes as you learn from customers, competitors, and your own experiments.

3

Detailed as Needed

Top items are detailed and ready for sprint. Lower items remain high-level until they move up in priority.

4

Product Owner Owned

The Product Owner owns the backlog but refines it with the team. Collaboration improves quality and shared understanding.

Backlog quality determines sprint quality. A weak backlog causes rework, missed goals, and team frustration. Invest in refinement.

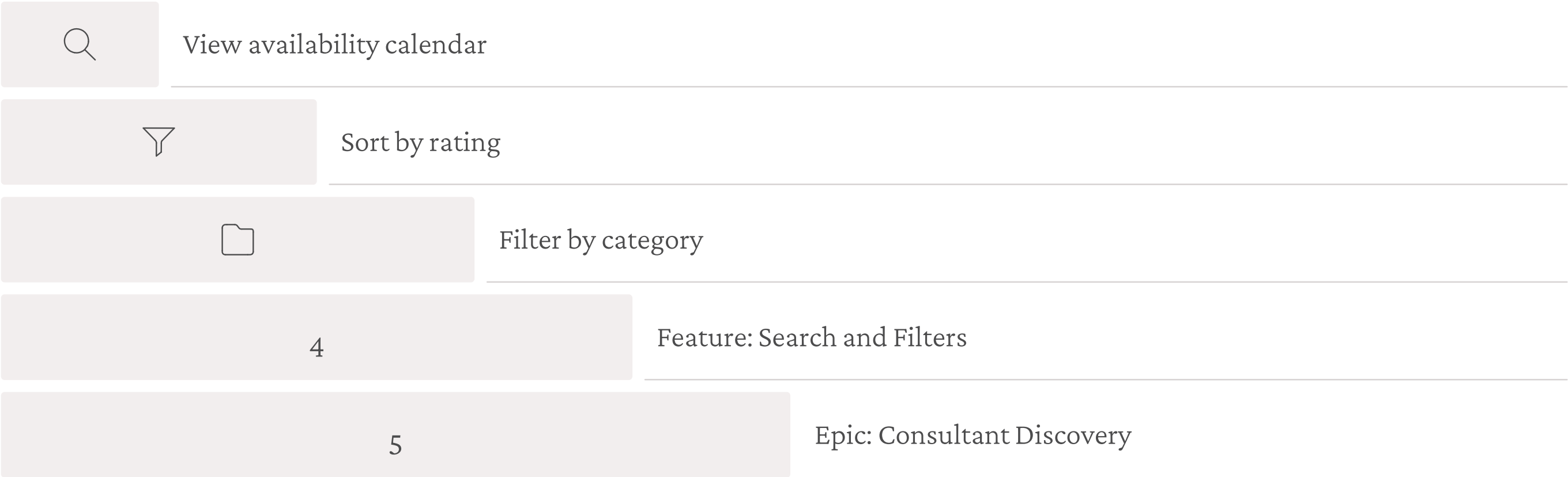
Backlog Structure: From Epics to Stories

	Epic Large outcome area or theme. Example: "Consultant Discovery"
	Feature Specific capability within an epic. Example: "Profile Search"
	User Story Slice of user value. Example: "As a client, I want to filter by expertise"
	Task Work unit
	Spike / Bug Time-boxed research to reduce uncertainty or defect

Keep Jira issue types clean and hierarchical. This structure prevents chaos in reporting and prioritization. Epics represent large outcome areas, features are capabilities, stories are user-facing value slices, and tasks are implementation units.

Backlog Hierarchy Example

ConsultNow Platform



Make it concrete. Epics break down into features, features break down into stories. Each level represents a different planning horizon.



User Story Writing

User, Need, Benefit Format

User Story

As a...

I want...

Acceptance Criteria

Priority

As a [user]

I want [need]

So that [benefit]

"As a client, I want to filter consultants by category, so that I can quickly find experts in my specific problem area."

Keep stories readable and user-centric. The format forces you to think from the user's perspective and articulate the value being delivered.



Estimation Basics

Relative Sizing Over Time Guesses

Compare stories to each other
rather than estimating absolute
hours

Story Points Reflect Complexity

Points capture effort, risk, and
unknowns—not just coding time

Estimation is for Forecasting

Use estimates to predict capacity
and plan releases, not to rate
performance

Emphasize healthy estimation culture. Points are a planning tool, not a productivity metric or performance evaluation.

Points vs Time

How to Explain to Stakeholders

Story Points

Represent relative effort, complexity, and uncertainty. A 5-point story is roughly twice as complex as a 3-point story.

Points are team-specific and improve forecasting accuracy over time.

Time Estimates

Calendar planning for stakeholder communication. Use historical velocity to translate points into delivery dates.

Example: Team velocity is 30 points per sprint. A 60-point epic will take approximately 2 sprints.

Stop teams from converting points to hours rigidly. The power of points is in relative comparison, not absolute conversion.





Estimation Basics: Affinity Estimation

Story points represent relative size—effort, risk, and unknowns combined. Affinity Estimation is a fast technique for sizing a backlog, especially useful in workshops where you need to estimate many stories quickly.

01

Pick Reference Stories

Choose 3 reference stories representing Small, Medium, and Large. These become your calibration points.

03

Discuss Outliers

Only discuss items placed far apart by different team members. This saves time and focuses on genuine disagreements.

02

Silent Grouping

Team members silently place remaining stories next to the closest reference. This prevents anchoring and groupthink.

04

Assign Points

Assign points to groups (1, 2, 3, 5, 8) and adjust a few items if needed. Use Fibonacci to reflect increasing uncertainty.

Affinity Estimation in Practice



📌 Healthy estimation avoids false precision. Use quick calibration: compare stories, assign relative sizes, and move on. Don't debate for hours.

Spikes for Research and Unknowns



What is a Spike?

A timeboxed research activity to reduce uncertainty. Used when the team lacks information to estimate or implement a story.

When to Use Spikes

Technical unknowns, integration feasibility, performance concerns, or architectural decisions. Never use spikes for vague exploration.

Spike Deliverables

Clear output: decision document, working prototype, integration notes, or recommendation with rationale.



Story Splitting

Why Teams Fail Without It

Big Stories Hide Risk

Complexity and unknowns remain invisible until too late in the sprint

Big Stories Delay Feedback

Nothing ships until everything is done, missing opportunities to learn and adjust

Big Stories Ruin Planning

Estimation becomes guesswork and sprint commitments become unreliable

Splitting is a core Product Owner skill and essential team capability. Master this and your velocity will stabilize dramatically.

Story Splitting Techniques

01

Split by Workflow Steps

Break the user journey into discrete steps (e.g., "Search" then "Filter" then "Sort")

03

Split by Complexity

Happy path first, then edge cases and error handling

Example: Booking flow—happy path first (available consultant, valid payment), then edge cases (unavailable times, payment failures).

02

Split by User Segment

Deliver for one persona first, then expand to others

04

Split by Data

Static data first, then dynamic or real-time data

MVP Prioritization: MoSCoW Method

Must Have

Critical for MVP launch. Without these, the product doesn't work or deliver core value. Example: Consultant profiles, booking flow.

Should Have

Important but not critical. Adds significant value but MVP can launch without them. Example: Advanced search filters, ratings.

Could Have

Nice to have if time permits. Enhances experience but not essential. Example: Consultant recommendations, saved searches.

Won't Have

Explicitly out of scope for this release. Protects focus and prevents scope creep. Example: Video consultations, payment processing.

Start with MoSCoW in workshops for fast alignment. It forces hard conversations about what's truly essential versus what's just desirable.



MVP Prioritization Exercise

- 1 — List Features
Brainstorm 10 potential features
- 2 — Score Quickly
Apply MoSCoW or RICE
- 3 — Choose MVP Slice
Select Must-haves only

The output becomes tomorrow's Sprint 1 candidate backlog. This exercise transforms vague ideas into actionable, prioritized work.



Product Planning

Total Timeline as Hypothesis

Initial roadmap is a best guess that will evolve with learning

Releases as Value Milestones

Each release delivers meaningful user value and enables feedback

Sprints as Learning Cycles

Regular delivery and inspection points to validate direction

Planning is progressive, not fixed. Embrace uncertainty and plan to replan as you learn more about users and market.

Release Planning Table

Timeline	Release	Outcome
Week 1-2	Release 0 (MVP Demo)	Search functionality, consultant profiles with trust signals, booking intent tracking
Week 3-4	Release 1	Complete booking submission flow, email confirmations, embedded feedback forms
Week 5-6	Release 2	Enhanced trust badges, usage analytics, automated feedback-to-backlog pipeline
Week 7-8	Release 3	Consultant onboarding, availability management, basic payment integration

Each release delivers measurable value and learning. Adjust subsequent releases based on feedback from earlier ones.



Jira Setup

What We Will Configure



Scrum Project

Create a new Scrum project with sprints and backlog enabled



Boards & Backlog

Set up sprint board and backlog view for team visibility



Issue Types & Workflows

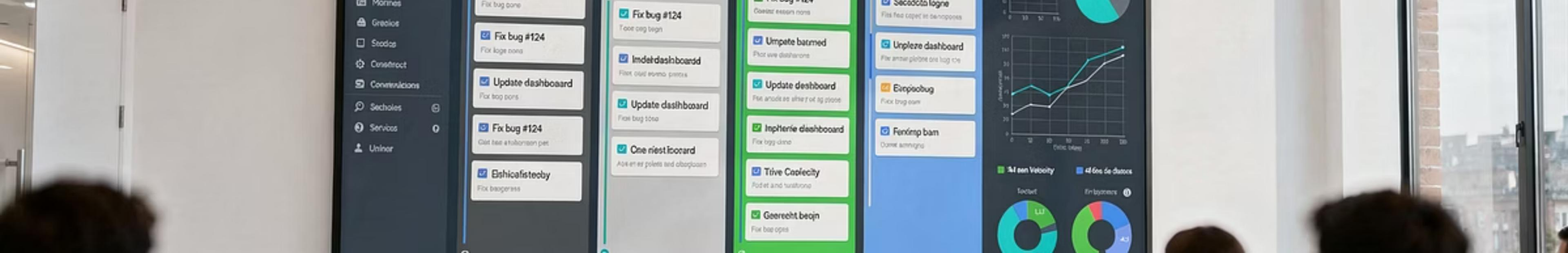
Configure Epic, Story, Bug, Spike with appropriate status flows



Releases & Versions

Define release milestones for roadmap tracking

We configure Jira to serve the process, not the other way around. The tool should enable your workflow, not dictate it.



Jira Workshop

Step-by-Step Configuration

01

Create Epics

Define major outcome areas for the product (e.g., Consultant Discovery, Booking System, Payment Processing)

03

Add Priorities and Estimates

Assign priority levels and story point estimates to each item

Show "good ticket" vs "bad ticket" live. A good ticket has clear title, user story format, acceptance criteria, and appropriate labels.

02

Add Stories Under Each Epic

Break down epics into deliverable user stories with clear acceptance criteria

04

Add Acceptance Criteria

Document testable conditions in story descriptions

Conclusion!

Reusable Workflow: Apply to Any Startup Idea



Discovery Phase

Customer interviews, competitor analysis, persona development, value proposition design using Lean Startup principles.



Definition Phase

PRD creation, backlog building, story writing, estimation using Scrum framework and AI assistance.



Implementation Phase

Sprint planning, execution, review, retrospective using Scrum ceremonies and Jira tracking.



Launch Phase

MVP deployment, feedback automation, pitch deck creation, fundraising using AI-accelerated workflows.

This workflow is repeatable for any startup idea and any product team. The combination of Lean Startup, Scrum, and AI tools creates a powerful system for rapid, validated product development.

Key Takeaways: Agile AI for Startups



Lean Startup Decides What

Use Build-Measure-Learn loops to validate hypotheses and reduce risk.
Focus on learning, not just building.



Scrum Delivers How

Use Scrum framework to deliver value in increments with transparency and continuous improvement.



AI Accelerates Speed

Use AI tools to draft, review, automate, and visualize—but humans make final decisions and apply judgment.



Customer Centricity Wins

Build a system to capture, analyze, and act on customer feedback within 48 hours. Speed of learning is competitive advantage.



Metrics Drive Decisions

Define success metrics upfront. Use data to decide whether to pivot or persevere, not opinions or assumptions.



Tools Enable, Process Guides

Tools like Jira, Make, Lovable, and Gamma are enablers. Process discipline and team collaboration are what actually deliver results.

Workshop Capstone Outputs

1

PRD Completed

Comprehensive product requirements document with personas, user journeys, and success metrics

2

Jira Backlog

Prioritized backlog with epics, stories, acceptance criteria, and estimates ready for execution

3

Lovable MVP

Working web application demonstrating core user flow from search to booking intent

4

Make Automation

Feedback-to-Jira pipeline running automatically, converting user input to actionable stories

5

Gamma Pitch Deck

Investor-ready presentation with narrative, metrics, roadmap, and ask



Your Journey Starts Now

From Idea to MVP in 3 Days

You now have a complete toolkit and repeatable process for transforming startup ideas into validated MVPs. The combination of Lean Startup principles, Scrum framework, and AI-powered tools gives you a significant competitive advantage.

3

Days

From idea to working MVP with
validated customer insights

5

Deliverables

PRD, Backlog, MVP, Automation,
Pitch Deck—all production-ready

∞

Applications

Apply this workflow to any
startup idea, any product, any
team

The best way to predict the future is to build it. Start with customer problems, validate with MVPs, iterate with Scrum, and accelerate with AI. Your startup journey begins today.

Thank you

[Waleed Kamel](#)